Sadly, the already dismal literacy rate in FATA further dwindled. According to a report prepared by the Society for the Protection of Rights of Child (SPARC), the literacy rate in FATA dropped sharply from 29 per cent to 17.42 per cent because of massive militancy in the area. The overall dropout rate from pre-school to fifth grade in primary schools over the last six years (2004–10) was 69 per cent, which included 63 per cent boys and 77 per cent girls. The overall dropout rate from class 6 to 10 over the last five years (2005–10) remained 54 per cent, with boys accounting for 53 per cent and girls 58 per cent (*Dawn*, 2011). Approximately 600,000 school-going children of KP reportedly missed one or more years of education due to ongoing militancy (*Dawn*, 2012).

TTP emulated Afghan Taliban to show their harsh side for Western education by destroying schools in KP. A total of 710 schools were destroyed or damaged by the militants. Swati TTP destroyed 640 schools in Malakand. More emphasis was on destroying girls' schools. It was in more than one way tragic that education for girls, in a part of Pakistan where literacy rate was already dismally low, was being hit in this way (*Dawn*, 2012).

Female teachers were harassed and attacked to prevent them from teaching. In 2009, in a tragic incident, two female teachers were shot dead in Bajaur Agency, after masked militants dragged them out of their vehicles and opened fire. Many schoolteachers quit their jobs for fear of being targeted. Across northern areas, one could see the burnt-out buildings of schools that had been attacked. However, when the Swati Taliban were flushed out by the army, the process of rebuilding almost 200 such structures was started (*The Nation*, 2009).

However, this was not the end of TTP's activities in Swat. As mentioned, Malala Yousafzai, a 14-year-old Swat girl, who stood up to protect the rights of the girls' education,[3] was attacked by militants on 9 October 2012. She was shot in her neck and head. TTP claimed responsibility and vowed to attack her again if she survived. It earned a sharp reaction from the people across Pakistan. All condemned the act in unison except the religious elements and parties. Political parties, lawyers, students and others took to rallies to protest against the attack on Malala. However, not even a single religius-political party made such a move. It further exposed the growing divide between the liberal and religious elements of the society.